

Dear Admission Committee,

REF: RECOMMENDATION FOR SWAIB OKITA OUMA, PF 31679

I am delighted to write this recommendation to contribute to Swaib's application. I have known him for seven months as his immediate supervisor at Equity Bank, Community Branch. Swaib was an exceptional employee under the *Equity Leadership Programme (ELP)*. Students are admitted to the ELP programme for having the highest scores nationally in the Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education examinations.

Equity Bank, Community Branch has a wide customer-base, which requires employees to handle massive amounts of money and interact with diverse customers, often high-profile clients. This, coupled with its unique location, plays a major role in deterring ELP scholars from applying to work at the branch. Nonetheless, Swaib took up the challenge. Unlike many others before him who had a notion that working as a teller is an unpleasant task, he insisted on being trained by the corporate cashier in order to learn about forex and money transfers.

Swaib would constantly arrive at the bank before everyone else. His unique walking style and ever jolly disposition, as well as his eloquence and confidence, highly endeared him to our customers. As a result, he cross-sold various bank products with ease. Swaib's service was beyond exceptional. He was the fastest teller we had in the branch, which led to improved service delivery and customer satisfaction. When the new bank program meant for serving elderly customers above 70 years old was initiated, he dedicated his counter to this, making the program a resounding success.

This year, Equity took a unique approach aimed at integrating its qualities in its employees: *Inter-Branch Culture Competitions*. Branches competed in singing the bank's anthem and answering questions about the bank's philosophies. Swaib played an indispensable role in his team, urging his colleagues to memorise the philosophies and even singing some parts of the chorus himself. His creativity was evident during the competitions; he selected some actions to accompany parts of the anthem to contribute to the aesthetic value of his team's performance. Furthermore, he brought some of his friends who had just formed a live band in order to beef up the branch's performance by adding vigour and gusto. On the day of the competition, one of our colleagues could not make it. Swaib volunteered to replace him, and to our surprise, he answered the questions courageously without hesitation. This went a long way in helping us secure the first runner's up position, and saw Swaib voted as the most creative and innovative employee in our Peer Analysis Review. When later asked, he admitted he had already decided to step up for the team. His ability to foresee potential setbacks and plot well-calculated moves to avoid and/or overcome such challenges was critical to the branch's success these seven months.

Swaib possesses an intellectual curiosity rare among his peers. He was once reading a book-*Blink* by Malcolm Gladwell-which argues that people can determine others' character traits at first interaction. Unconvinced and in search of the truth, Swaib drafted two questionnaires for his colleagues and sought their responses. His action was a subtle influence to his co-workers and I to give the book a look. We were all in awe of what would push this young man to such an extra mile in pursuit of knowledge.

Ever innovative, Swaib was at the forefront of finding better ways to undertake bank procedures. He bugged me with questions on bank procedures and constantly put forward different ways of doing things. I particularly remember how he took note of the fact that there was a glitch in how the branch took stock, managed store, and reordered the stock. He took it upon himself, through a software company he co-founded with his elder brother (www.treob.co.ke), to design a computerised system capable of handling all those tasks. More impressive is how he followed up with several levels of bank hierarchy to have this system integrated. It is currently under review and he hopes it will be implemented soon.

I will forever be in admiration of Swaib's honesty and integrity. One of our customers accidentally left fifteen thousand Kenyan shillings on Swaib's counter. Unable to reach him via both phone and email, Swaib safeguarded the customer's money and returned it to him upon his next visit to the bank the following day. Working with Swaib was a great joy. The fact that he is an amazing conversationalist made him the life of our branch. Furthermore, his down-to-earth personality directed his politeness towards subordinate members of staff. He volunteered to assist them with arduous routines, such as opening the trap door to the back office. Indeed, he epitomizes humility.

It is for these reasons and more that I believe that Swaib would be an exceptional addition to your distinguished institution's student body. His innovation, curiosity, team spirit, and predisposition for selfless service will forever leave a mark on Equity Bank Branch, Community. I look forward to seeing him advancing his personal and intellectual aspirations.

Yours faithfully,

Ruth Kamiti,



Equity Bank, Community Branch.

